



AFRICAN DEVELOPMENT BANK GROUP
GROUPE DE LA BANQUE AFRICAINE
DE DEVELOPPEMENT



Data Innovation for Africa

DATA INNOVATION LAB · AfDB

Data Innovation for Africa (D4IA)

From Promise to Practice

Institutionalise

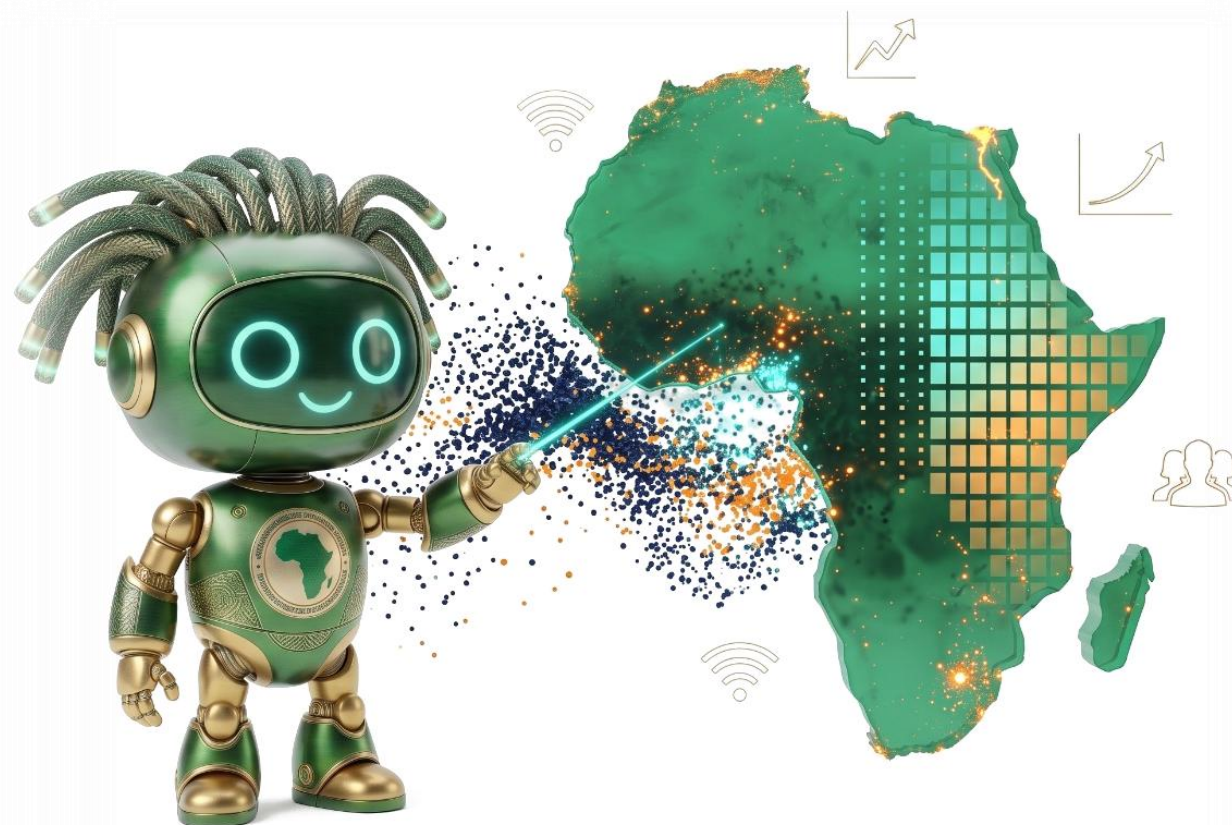


Prove

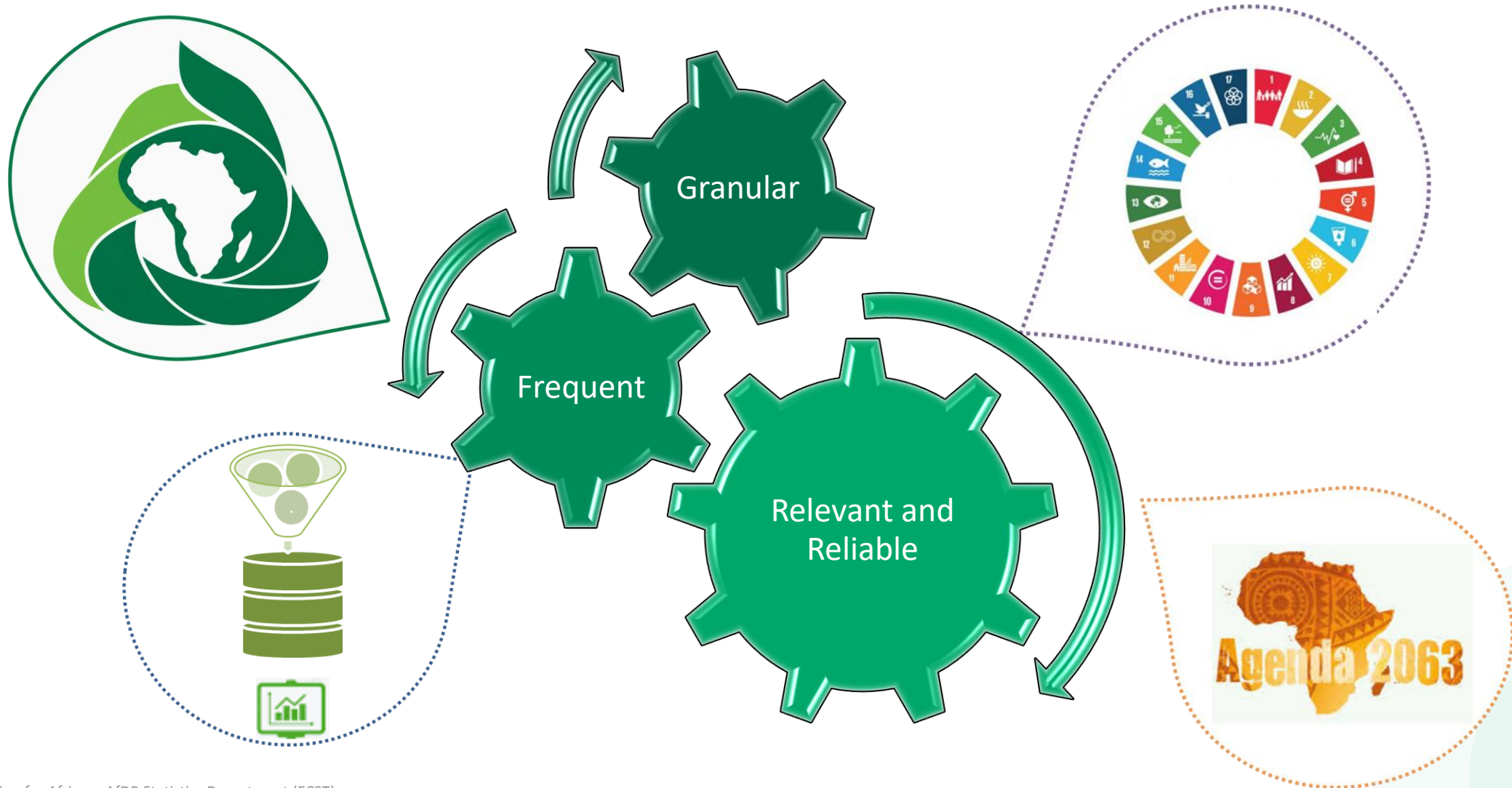


Build capacity

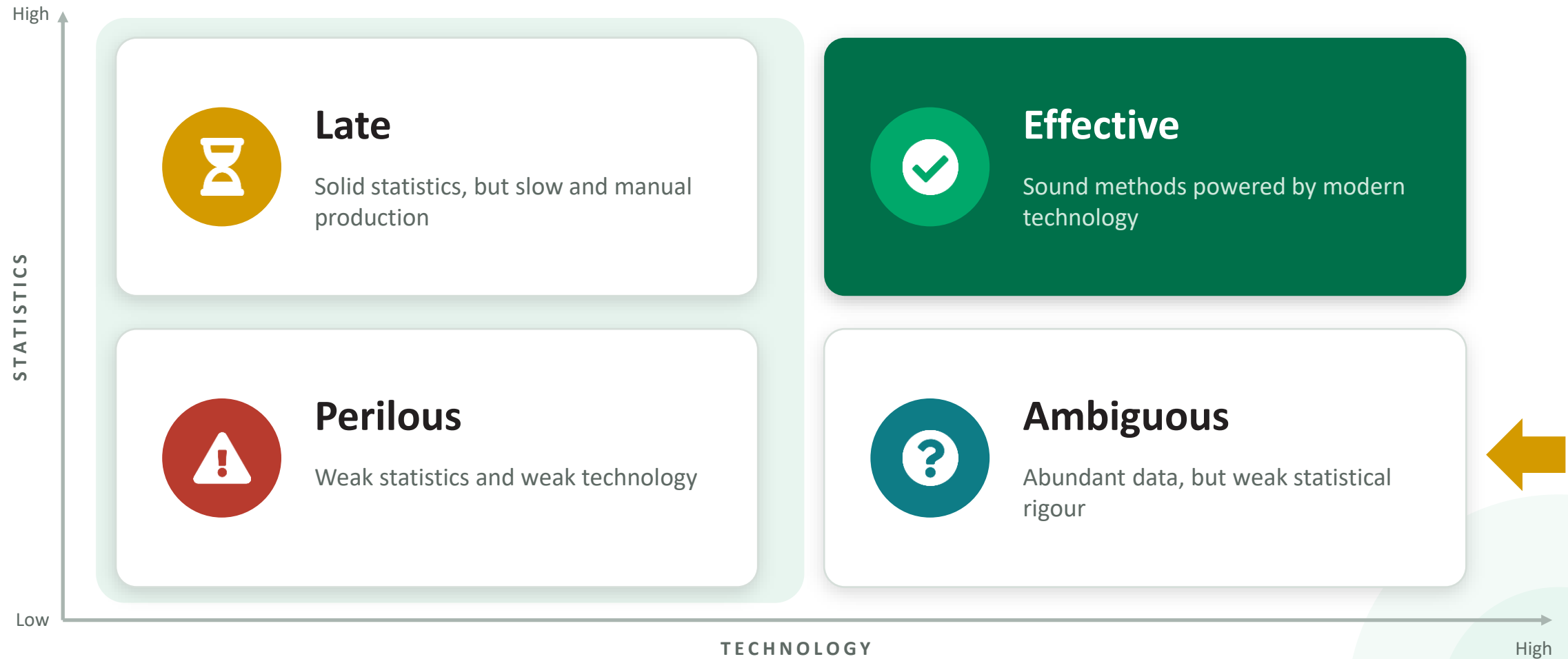
Statistics Department (ECST)
African Development Bank Group



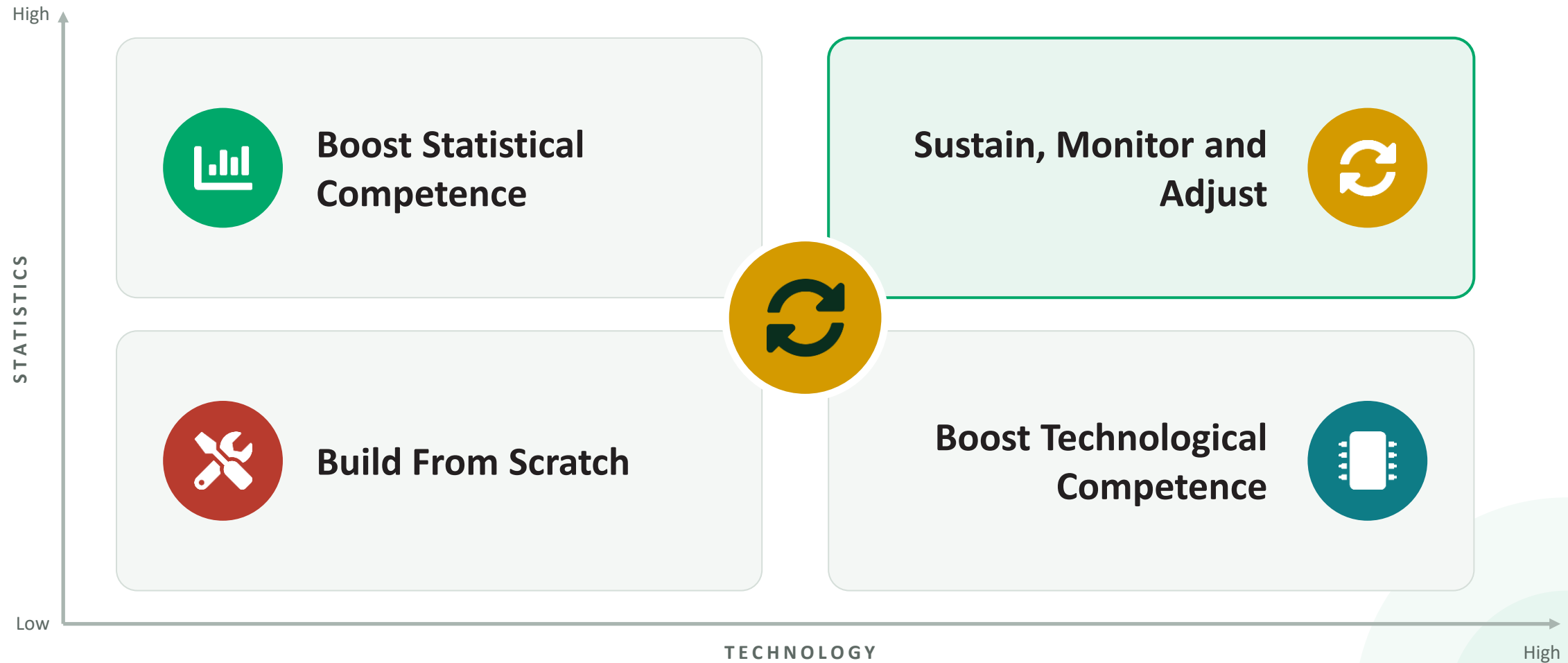
Development agendas demand better data



When statistics and technology fall out of step



A tailored response for every starting point



Better decisions start with better data

01 Better understand the world in which we live — and its causalities

02 Better decisions with immediate impact...
must be driven by data that is:



Reliable



Real time



Granular

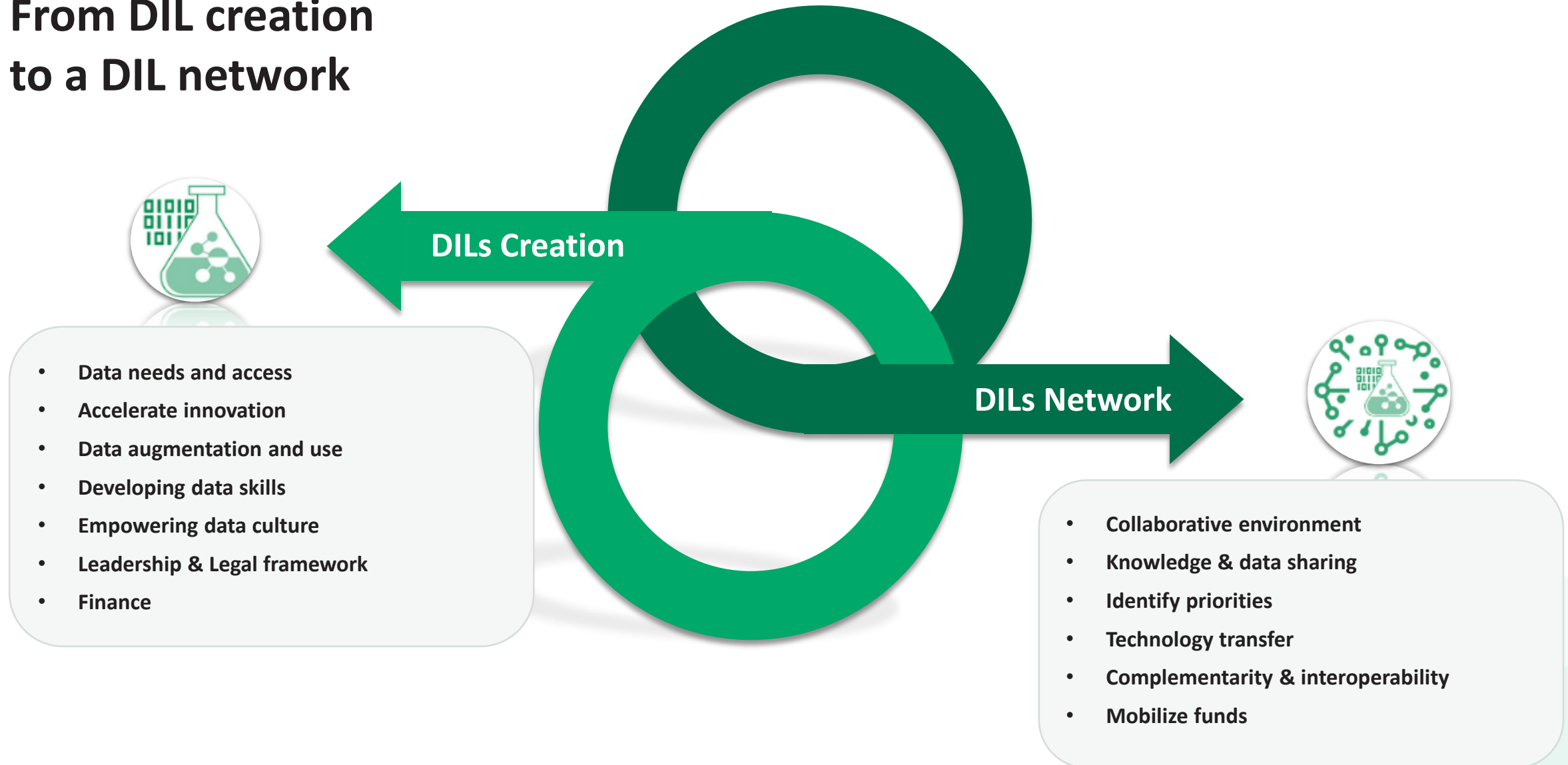


Forward looking



Integrated

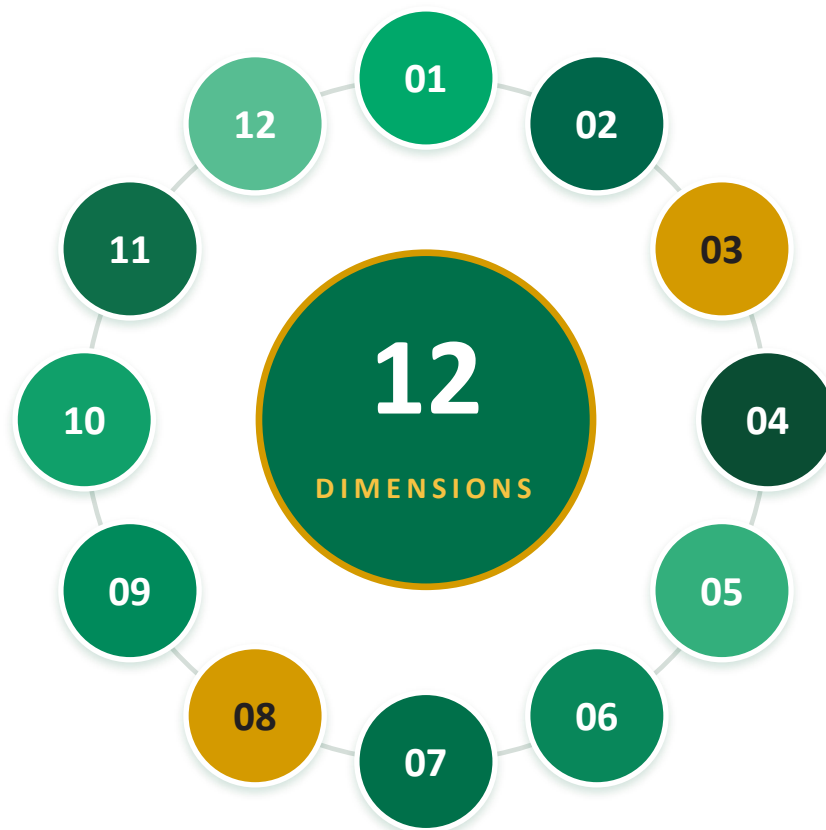
From DIL creation to a DIL network



The Data Innovation Maturity Model

THE 12 DIMENSIONS

- 01 Leadership & membership
- 02 Strategic transformation vision
- 03 Legal & institutional framework
- 04 Human resources
- 05 Information technology
- 06 Financing
- 07 Partnerships
- 08 Expertise in research & analysis
- 09 Quality, norms & standards
- 10 Non-traditional sources
- 11 Communication
- 12 Comms & user relations



APPLIED IN 8 RMCs



- | | |
|-----------------|------------|
| 1 Tunisia | 5 Cameroon |
| 2 Senegal | 6 Zambia |
| 3 Côte d'Ivoire | 7 Botswana |
| 4 Nigeria | 8 Morocco |



Support Data Innovation Lab (DIL) creation in RMCs: through the Bank's Data Innovation Maturity Model — a 12-dimension diagnostic applied in 8 countries to guide national action plans.

The DIL Network



Knowledge sharing across labs

Facilitate continuous exchange of expertise



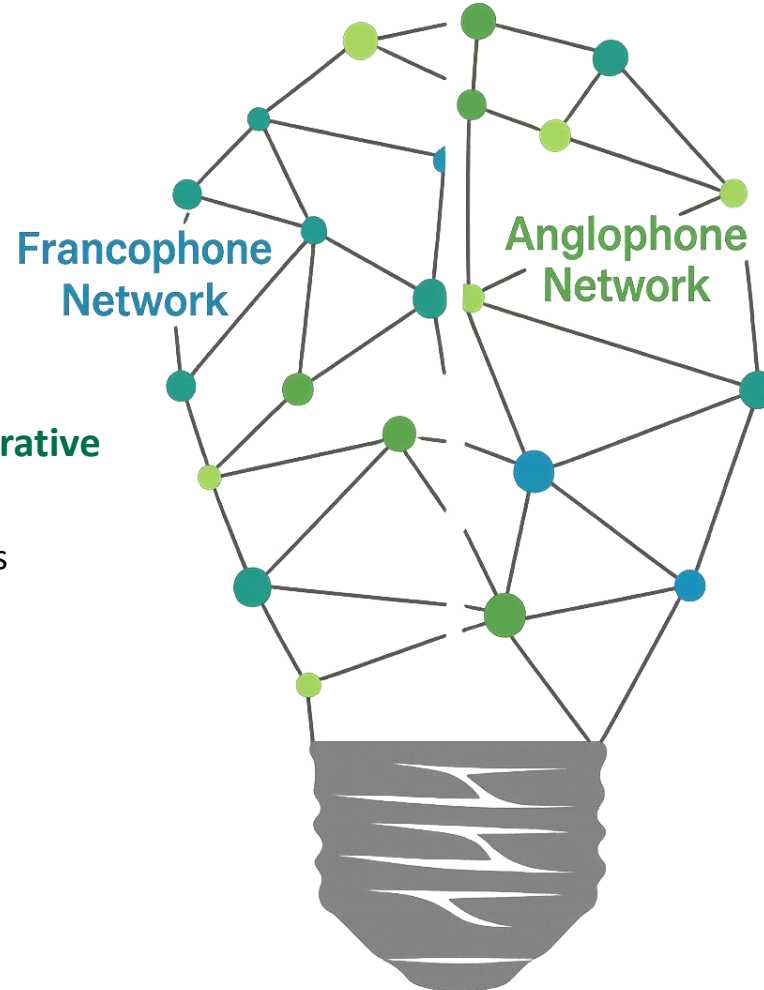
Cross-country collaborative projects

Encourage joint initiatives between DILs



Standardized data governance practices

Develop and promote harmonized frameworks



Capacity building and training programs

Organize workshops, certifications, and mentorship programs



Open innovation platform

Create a shared digital platform



Innovation challenges and hackathons

Host regular innovation challenges and hackathons



DIL Network

Data Innovation Lab: from non-traditional data to development insight



Accessibility Indicator

Geospatial distance-and-time analysis measuring people's real access to schools, health facilities & education — piloted in Rwanda's Nyagatare District.



Nighttime Lights

NASA satellite radiance analysed across Africa to track economic activity and resilience where official statistics are thin — feeding development planning.



Displacement Mapping

Satellite lights × Meta settlement data to track forced displacement across conflict-affected countries.



Connectivity Gaps

Ookla × Meta data maps underserved populations across 11 East African countries to target investment.



The engine: the Data Innovation Lab (DIL). Each product runs on governed, licensed data — turning legal access into analytical capability, and analytics into development outcomes in health, energy, education and digital inclusion.

From standards to practice

- ✓ **Applied problem-solving** through real use cases
- ✓ **Project-based learning** for national priorities
- ✓ **Data collection & integration** aligned with standards
- ✓ **Big Data technologies** for official statistics
- ✓ **End-to-end data pipelines** ensuring quality & traceability
- ✓ **Infrastructure as Code** for scalable deployments
- ✓ **AI-ready data infrastructures** supporting innovation





Emerging Issues, Emerging Practice

A capacity-building workshop delivered by the **African Development Bank** with **AU STATAFRIC**, under Specialized Technical Group 17 of SHaSA II — AI, large language models and big data for official statistics.

 **28 September – 2 October 2026**

 **Kigali, Rwanda · English & French**

**5**
days of intensive, hands-on training

**27**
contact hours with expert facilitators

**12**
hands-on laboratories, each with a fallback

**2**
languages — every notebook in EN & FR

THE WEEK · ONE PIPELINE, FIVE DAYS

**DAY 1**
AI Concepts
AI, LLMs, RAG, agents & MCP; NSO infrastructure and sovereignty

**DAY 2**
Prompt Engineering
Designing prompts; choosing models and inference providers

**DAY 3**
Non-Traditional Data
Ookla Speedtest & WorldPop; bias, access and big-data tools

**DAY 4**
Night-Time Lights
A proxy indicator validated against official subnational figures

**DAY 5**
Publishing & Results
Reproducible products on GitHub; country presentations

Source: STG17 workshop website — datainnov4africa-web.github.io/stg17-workshop (accessed September 2026).

From STG17's action plan to concrete working pipelines

SCAN TO ACCESS THE WORKSHOP



Workshop website

datainnov4africa-web.github.io/stg17-workshop

Agenda, labs, notebooks and slides in English & French.
Create your free accounts before you arrive.

THANK YOU · MERCI

Reveal the Power of **Data** in Africa

Data Innovation for Africa (DI4A) · Statistics Department (ECST)



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